

7 Expert-Approved Holiday Savings Strategies

1 Utilize online and in-person shopping.

Consumers no longer spend all their time shopping online: 55 percent of buyers plan to make purchases digitally, 44 percent at department stores, and 42 percent at discounters. Follow your favorite stores on social media and sign up for any emails or newsletters they offer so that you never miss a deal. (Pro tip: Opt OUT of these options after the holidays to avoid frivolous spending. I'm not endorsing any of these, because I haven't used them, but Trimbox, Clean Email, and Leave Me Alone are companies that, at the time of printing this, promise to help you unsubscribe.)



2 Don't miss out on price matching.

Most big retailers offer some version of a holiday price match system, so it never hurts to ask. Target, for example, often runs some kind of price match through November and December.



3 Get the most out of tech tools.

Whether you're shopping online or in person, there's an app for that. For example, Karma and Honey find and apply coupons when you checkout online and track price drops online, or you can use ShopSavvy to compare prices while shopping in-store.



4 Purchase your produce pre-bagged.

If you're trying to save on holiday food shopping, stores often price their pre-packaged foods by volume, so grabbing the heaviest bag will get you more food for the same price, said finance expert Andrea Woroch. (Pro tip: Stores may offer additional discounts on foods or products that are considered "ugly," like dented cans. Hey ... they still taste the same.)



5 Get out that credit card.

I would never advocate for using your credit card for payments unless you pay it off in full every month. However ... if you budget for your spending and don't carry credit card debt, then using your card to make all of your purchases is a great way to make the most of any additional benefits it may offer, like cash back, discounts on the stores where you shop the most, or cheaper travel for all those holiday plans.



7 Use Black Friday to get your regular shopping done, too.

According to one study, 44 percent of Americans have been waiting for holiday sales events like Black Friday to find items they need, including 28 percent who plan to use those sales to purchase everyday items like groceries and household goods. "Thinking beyond gifts is crucial when approaching holiday sales events," Woroch said. "Look out for savings on local services, too, like dental care, fitness packages, and more."



6 Buy Now Pay Later ... as long as you've done your research.

According to PayPal's 2025 Holiday Shopping Survey, 50 percent holiday shoppers plan to use buy now, pay later options to cover their bills. This can be a good way to manage your cash flow over the course of a few months, as long as you always read the fine print. Never use a BNPL options without understanding the payment terms you're getting into. (ie: What interest am I paying? What happens if I don't pay it off in time?) If you do end up deciding to go with BNPL, find an option that provides you with even more benefits. For example, PayPal has been known to offer 20 percent cash back on any buy now, pay later purchases made during a specific holiday season timeframe, and 5 percent back on other dates through the rest of the year.

